

Module 11: Migrant Lives and Identities

Signature Learning Experience

Purpose

Students analyze how migration reshapes identity and belonging — through an identity map of a real person's intersecting identities (from published narrative or consenting participant) or a case-based analysis of one identity dimension. The discipline is intersectionality used as an analytical tool, not a buzzword.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe identity dynamics — formation, negotiation, belonging (UG 1)
- Identify forms of exclusion the person or group encounters (UG 2)
- Explain intersectionality through concrete, specific analysis (UG 3)
- Recognize diversity within migrant communities — no monoliths (UG 4)

Graduate extension

Graduate students extend to policy: take one identity intersection (e.g., gender and asylum credibility; disability and refugee resettlement; statelessness and children's rights) and analyze how a specific policy treats it, with disaggregated evidence where available (Grad 1–2).

Assignment steps

1. Choose your track. Track A (identity map): select a published first-person source — memoir, long-form interview, documentary — from the module's list or with approval. Track B (case analysis): select one identity dimension and one migrant population.
2. For Track A: map the person's intersecting identities (age, gender, legal status, language, religion, class, disability) and how each shaped their migration and belonging — noting where identities compound and where they conflict.
3. For Track B: gather evidence on how the chosen dimension shapes outcomes for the population — disaggregated data where it exists, qualitative scholarship where it doesn't.
4. In both tracks: identify at least one exclusion mechanism (legal, social, economic) and one belonging/resilience strategy visible in your material.
5. Apply intersectionality precisely: show an outcome that cannot be explained by any single identity category alone.
6. Write the analysis; workshop one page of it in the seminar session before final submission.

Deliverables & format

- Identity map (visual) plus analysis, or case analysis — 1,500–1,800 words either track (graduate: 2,500 with policy application)
- Evidence list with a note on what each source contributed
- One-paragraph reflection on the limits of your analysis — what you cannot know from outside

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Analytical precision — intersectionality demonstrated, not invoked 35%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: analytical precision — intersectionality demonstrated, not invoked goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: analytical precision — intersectionality demonstrated, not invoked is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: analytical precision — intersectionality demonstrated, not invoked is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: analytical precision — intersectionality demonstrated, not invoked is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Evidence quality and respectful use of narrative material 25%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: evidence quality and respectful use of narrative material is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: evidence quality and respectful use of narrative material is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: evidence quality and respectful use of narrative material is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: evidence quality and respectful use of narrative material is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Identification of exclusion mechanisms and agency 25%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: identification of exclusion mechanisms and agency goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: identification of exclusion mechanisms and agency is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: identification of exclusion mechanisms and agency is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: identification of exclusion mechanisms and agency is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Clarity of writing and visuals 15%	Communication is publication-ready: clarity of writing and visuals is achieved with precise, well-organized prose, correct citation, and figures or formats that make the argument easier to grasp.	Communication is clear and professional: clarity of writing and visuals is achieved with minor lapses in polish, organization, or citation that never obscure meaning.	Communication is understandable but rough: clarity of writing and visuals is only partly achieved — disorganization, citation errors, or unclear figures make the reader work to follow the argument.	Communication impedes the work: clarity of writing and visuals is not achieved; errors, disorganization, or missing citations obscure the substance.